

Gabler Wins;
Bears First

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Manager Andy Cohen of Denver borrowed some strategy from Manager Gene Mauch of Minneapolis Wednesday night to save the Bears' 3-1 victory over the Millers at Metropolitan stadium before 3,096 fans.

Cohen used a pitcher-to-the-outfield—and back-to-the mound switch in the eighth inning to stymie the Millers short of gaining a 2-2 tie.

The Bears regained the American Association lead over Charleston.

FRANK GABLER, Denver's league-leading right-hander, returned from left field to pick up his 15th triumph against two losses. Lefty Ed Donnelly retired southpaw-swinging Paul Smith of the Millers in the eighth to help Gabler over a rough spot.

The Bears carried a 2-1 edge into the eighth when pinch-hitter Lu Clinton, batting for loser Al Schroll, walked to open the inning. Pumpsie Green sacrificed the tying run to second and Mauch also drew a walk.

So Cohen beckoned Donnelly from the bullpen to retire Smith on a hopper to second base, the runners moving up a base. Art Schult, who hit his 12th homer for the Millers' lone run in the second, was purposely passed to load the runways.

GABLER AMBLED back from left field to pet Red Robbins for the final out on a line drive to Donnelly, who was now established as the right fielder.

Gabler, the knuckleball expert who worked a five-hitter, pitched through the ninth in 1-2-3 fashion after the Bears had picked up an insurance run in the top half off the relieving Tom Borland on two walks and Green's error.

Schroll, who had won two in a row for a 4-1 record, dropped a tough seven-hitter for his second loss. He gave up four singles to Denver in a damaging two-run second inning, but grew stronger as the game progressed.

IN THE DENVER SECOND, Gordon Windhorn and Dick Sanders opened with solid singles to left. They moved up on an infield out and Windhorn scored on Fritz Brickell's one-base shot to center.

Gabler fanned before Gene Hassell coaxed a walk and Curt Roberts singled for a 2-0 lead.

Then Schult came up with his wallop over the left-field fence. The Bears, however, turned two double plays to stop the Millers just short the rest of the way.

Mauch had thrice used Cohen's pitching strategy to win for the Millers this season, the latest Tuesday night in St. Paul.

DUGOUT DOPE: Tonight at 8:15 the third-place Millers rely on right-hander Bert Thiel (6-5) to tame the Bears, who will counter with lanky Mark Freeman (8-4) on the mound...

MILLER BOX SCORE

Denver (3)	AB	R	H	BI	E
Hassell, 2b	4	0	0	0	0
Roberts, 2b	3	0	2	1	0
Steele, 1b	4	0	1	0	0
Brickell, c	4	0	0	0	0
Windhorn, cf	3	1	2	0	0
Sanders, cf	4	1	0	0	0
Henderson, lf	2	0	0	0	0
Donnelly, p-r	0	0	0	0	0
Brickell, ss	4	0	1	1	0
Gabler, p-lp	4	0	0	0	0
o-Bull	0	0	0	0	0
o-Johnson, lf	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	33	3	7	3	0

MINNEAPOLIS (1)	AB	R	H	BI	E
Green, ss	3	0	0	0	1
Alsch, 2b	3	0	0	0	0
Smith, 1b	4	0	0	0	0
Schult, lf	2	1	1	1	0
Robbins, cf	4	0	0	0	0
Barford, p	0	0	0	0	0
Sidwell, c	4	0	0	0	0
Unphardt, cf	4	0	2	0	0
Mainsburg, 2b	3	0	0	0	0
Schroll, p	2	0	0	0	1
o-Clinton, cf	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	33	1	3	1	2